

AMBER X. CHEN

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EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Barbara

PhD Candidate in Social Psychology

Thesis: *Contextualized Person Perception*, Advisor: Prof. Hongbo Yu

Sep 2022 – (expected May 2027)

Santa Barbara, CA, USA

Master's in Computer Science

Sep 2025 – (expected May 2027)

The Chinese University of Hong Kong

Master's in Psychology

Thesis: *Motivation Impacts Emotion Recognition through Attentional Selection*, Advisor: Prof. Helene H. Fung

Nov 2017

Hong Kong SAR, China

Sun Yat-sen University

Bachelor's in Sociology

Thesis: *An Empirical Analysis of Chinese Social Class Schema Based on CLDS 2016*, Advisor: Prof. Yucheng Liang

Jun 2016

Guangdong, China

PUBLICATIONS

Cao, J.*, **Chen, A. X.***, Mai, C.*, & Fung, H. H. (submitted). Age Bias in People's Daily Across 72 Years. doi: [10.31234/osf.io/2bf56](https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/2bf56)

Zeng, J., Liu, S., Sun, Z., & **Chen, A. X.**(submitted). A Study on the Formation of Age Stereotypes Based on Causal Inference: A Comparison of Chinese and USA Cultures.

Chen, A. X., Sun, S., & Yu, H. (2024). Moral attitudes towards effort and efficiency: A comparison between American and Chinese history. *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*, 11(1), 1–14. doi: [10.1057/s41599-024-03603-3](https://doi.org/10.1057/s41599-024-03603-3)

Mai, C., Chen, D., Olivos, F., & **Chen, A. X.** (2024). Disentangling Stereotypes towards Older Age Groups: Evidence from Factorial Survey Experiments in China and the USA. *Gerontology*, 70(2), 210–234. doi: [10.1159/000534680](https://doi.org/10.1159/000534680)

Chen, Y., **Chen, A. X.**, Yu, H., & Sun, S. (2024). Unraveling moral and emotional discourses on social media: a study of three cases, *Information, Communication Society*, 27(7), 1295–1312. doi: [10.1080/1369118X.2023.2246551](https://doi.org/10.1080/1369118X.2023.2246551)

Galkin, F., Kochetov, K., Koldasbayeva, D., Fung, H. H., **Chen, A. X.**, & Zhavoronkov, A. (2022). Psychological factors substantially contribute to biological aging: Evidence from the aging rate in Chinese older adults. *Psychology and Aging*, 14(18), 7206–7222. doi: [10.1037/pag0000696](https://doi.org/10.1037/pag0000696)

Chen, A. X.*, Tsang, V. H. L.*, Wong, J. T. K.*, Fung, H. H., & Ayalon, L. (2020). Three Ways that Ageing Affects Women Differently from Men: Menopause, Changes in Physical Appearance and Caregiving. In *Cambridge Handbook of the International Psychology of Women*. Fanny M. Cheung & Diane F. Halpern. (Eds.), (pp. 124–136). Cambridge: Cambridge University Press. doi: [10.1017/9781108561716.012](https://doi.org/10.1017/9781108561716.012)

Fung, H. H., Chu, S. T. W., Jiang, D., **Chen, A. X.**, & Ng, C. C. (2020). Contrasting the Effects of Mortality Salience and Future Time Limitation on Goal Prioritization in Older and Younger Adults. *Journal of Gerontology: Psychological Sciences* 75(10), 2112–2121. doi: [10.1093/geronb/gbz133](https://doi.org/10.1093/geronb/gbz133)

*Co-first authors contributed equally to this work.

INVITED TALK

Invited Participant, *A Neurocomputational Framework for Mapping Social Relationships: Insights from EEG*. Bridging the Inter-Disciplinary Gap in the Mathematical Modeling of Social Phenomena Workshop. Banff International Research Station (BIRS), Alberta, Canada. November 2-7 2025

CONFERENCES

- Chen, A. X.** & Yu, H. (2026, April 15 - 18). *Social Networks Shape How We Form Impressions*. Social and Affective Neuroscience Society Conference (SANS) 2026 Annual Conference [Oral Presentation]. San Diego, CA, USA.
- Chen, A. X.** & Yu, H. (2025, April 23 - 27). *A dual-route model of social trait perception from face: Dissociating the perceptual and conceptual contributions behaviorally and neurally*. Social and Affective Neuroscience Society Conference (SANS) 2025 Annual Conference [Oral Presentation]. Chicago, IL, USA.
- Chen, A. X.**, Cao, R., Wang, S., & Yu, H. (2024, February 7-10). *Contextualized Social Information Predicts Neuronal Representation of Social Traits Perceived from Faces*. Computational Psychology Preconference, Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP) 2024 Annual Convention [Oral Presentation]. San Diego, CA, USA.
- Chen, A. X.**, Sun, S., & Yu, H. (2023, February 22-25). *Moralization of unproductive effort: Cross-cultural and historical analysis based on Natural Language Processing*. Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP) 2023 Annual Convention [Poster Presentation]. Atlanta, GA, USA.
- Chen, A. X.**, Lu, M., & Fung, H. H. (2022, March 30 - April 2). *Cultural differences in the prevalence and spread of emotional complexity on social media*. The Society for Affective Science (SAS) 2022 Annual Conference [Oral Presentation]. Online.
- Chen, A. X.**, & Fung, H. H. (2020, November 4-7). *Individualism increases the influence of perceived competence of older adults on attitudes toward them*. The Gerontological Society of America (GSA) Annual Scientific Meeting [Poster Presentation]. Online.
- Chen, A. X.**, Fung, H. H., & Liang, Y. (2019, October 3-5). *The instrumentality of emotion on social media: Self-relevance as a moderator in emotional sharing*. The 2019 Technology, Mind & Society Conference [Poster Presentation]. Washington, D.C., USA.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Motivation and Emotion Laboratory, The Chinese University of Hong Kong

Lab Manager

Sept 2017 – July 2022

- Managed research projects on cultural differences and emotions using psychophysiological techniques, experience sampling, and surveys; Supervised undergraduate research assistants

Center for Social Survey, Sun Yat-sen University

Research Assistant

May 2014 – August 2016

- Managed data collection for the Chinese Education Panel Survey (CEPS; 2014-2016).

RESEARCH GRANTS

General Research Fund

August 2023 – April 2026

Research Grants Council of Hong Kong

Project: Age Differences in Information Spreading: A Social Network Perspective

Role: Co-Investigator, Leading Facebook Study; Amount: HKD 1,042,719

Social Science Research Impact Fund

June 2021 – Feb 2023

Faculty Office of Social Science, The Chinese University of Hong Kong

Project: Increasing preparation of ageing and decreasing negative age stereotypes by increasing self-relevance

Role: Co-Investigator, Leading Weibo Study; Amount: HKD 500,000

Interdisciplinary Research Seed Funding

August 2021 – April 2022

Faculty Office of Social Science, The Chinese University of Hong Kong

Project: Age stereotypes across time and the roles of self-relevance: A computational social science approach

Role: Principal Investigator; Amount: HKD 15,000

Tencent Anthropology Fieldwork Grant

June 2014 - December 2015

Tencent Research Institute, Tencent Holdings Ltd, China

Project: How Adolescents Adopt Different Perceptions of the Same Social Network: The Role of Network Position

Role: Principal Investigator; Amount: CNY 3,000

AWARDS AND HONORS

African and Asian Students in STEM Scholarship, UCSB	2025
Highlighted Poster Award, The 2019 Technology, Mind & Society, Washington, D.C., USA.	2019
Academic Excellence Scholarship (top 5%), School of Sociology and Anthropology, SYSU	2014 - 2015
Third Place Award at Survey Contest of Political Affairs, Guangdong Province	2014
Second Place Award at Social Investigation Contest of Social Issues, SYSU	2014
Outstanding Individual Scholarship, SYSU	2013 - 2014

PROFESSIONAL TRAINING

NeuroAI (Funded by Individualized Professional Skills Grant, UCSB)	Jul 14 - 28 2025
Modules: task structure, microcircuitry, neural architecture, learning rules.	Neuromatch Academy
Konstanz School of Collective Behavior (Fully funded)	Jul 22 - Aug 9, 2024
Focuses: Modeling collective behaviors of animals and humans.	University of Konstanz, Germany
NeuroDataReHack (Accommodation funded)	Jul 8-12, 2024
Focuses: Collaborative neuroinformatics projects and data science. Howard Hughes Medical Institute, Virginia, USA	
Certified Carpentries Instructor Training	Mar 2025
Courses: Carpentries Pedagogical Model, Build a Workshop Website, Participatory Live Coding	The Carpentries
Big Data Analytics	Jan - Mar 2024
Courses: Big Data Fundamentals/Feature Engineering/Machine Learning with PySpark	DataCamp
Summer Institute in Computational Social Science	Jul - Aug 2016
Modules: Information Diffusion in Online Social Networks, Agent-based Social Simulation, etc.	SYSU
Summer Institute in Advanced Quantitative Methods (Travel and accommodation funded)	Jul 2014
Modules: Multilevel Modeling, Counterfactual Model of Causality, etc.	Xi'an Jiaotong University, China

TEACHING EXPERIENCES

Teaching Assistant , UCSB	Sep 2022 - Present
Computational Neuroscience, Social Neuroscience, Research Methods, Statistical Methods, Social Psychology, Biopsychology	

SKILLS

- Proficient in Natural Language Processing, Machine Learning, and Social Network Analysis
- Experienced in using PsychoPy, E-Prime, neuroimaging techniques, and eye-tracking techniques,
- Language and Software: Python, R, Matlab, Stata, and SPSS; FSL and Workbench

COMMUNITY SERVICES

Reviewer , Humanities and Social Sciences Communications	2026
Reviewer , Motivation & Emotion	2026
Statistics Fellow , Department of Psychological and Brain Sciences, UCSB	2023/24
Coordinator of Journal Club ReproducibiliTea	2023-2025

Mentor for graduate applications

Chenxi Liu, University of Arizona

2025/26

Ying Ye, University of Melbourne

2024/25

Qingyi Li, Virginia Tech

Yichen Wang, Cornell

2023/24

Jing Chen, Virginia Tech

Yinbo Zheng, University of Georgia

Kun Wang, Baylor University

Weifang Huang, Boston College

Leyi Zhuang, CUHK

Junsong Lu, UCSD

2022/23

Lyu Meng, Boston College

Yilin Kou, The Hong Kong Polytechnic University